# Riccardo Pala

## Software & AI Engineer

Milan, Italy | Open to relocation to Barcelona | +39 349 058 5195 | riccardo.pala98@outlook.it | LinkedIn • GitHub

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software & AI Engineer with 3+ years building Java/Spring Boot systems and LLM-powered RAG platforms in production for two of Italy's largest banking groups. Works on backend systems, financial data services and RAG workflows. M.Sc. studies focused on Machine Learning and Deep Learning.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Silicon Shoring FS Reply

**Senior Consultant | Jun 2023 – Present | Milan, Italy**

**Conversational PFM & Agentic RAG Platform | Feb 2026 – Present | Major Italian banking group**

- **Data Enrichment & Ingestion:** Develop Java/Spring Boot services and financial data components for merchant normalization, categorization and geolocation, with emphasis on concurrency and low latency.
- **RAG Application & Semantic Retrieval:** Contribute to a Python Agentic RAG system that combines structured and embedding-based search with PostgreSQL/pgvector, similarity ranking and relevance thresholds to retrieve transaction context for LLM responses.
- **Technical Leadership & Stakeholder Engagement:** Act as a technical reference for the client and development team, guide technical decisions, coordinate engineering activities and lead project status reviews.

**Web & Mobile Banking Platforms | Jun 2023 – Present | Major Italian banking group**

- **Backend Engineering:** Design and deliver Java/Spring Boot REST APIs and microservices, Kafka event-driven integrations and Oracle-backed services for production banking platforms.
- **Solution Design & Estimation:** Translate requirements into technical solutions, contribute to architecture decisions and prepare effort and cost estimates for new developments and change requests.
- **Delivery Coordination:** Coordinate planning, task definition and progress tracking while monitoring delivery and financial performance of assigned projects.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**AI & RAG:** Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Agentic RAG, LLM integration, embeddings, vector search, PostgreSQL/pgvector, semantic retrieval, Python, PyTorch, scikit-learn
**Backend:** Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs, microservices, concurrency, multithreading, SQL, performance optimization
**Infrastructure & Data:** Apache Kafka, Oracle DB, AWS, OpenShift/Kubernetes, Docker, Jenkins/CI/CD, Dynatrace

## EDUCATION

**Politecnico di Milano** | M.Sc. Computer Science & Engineering (AI) | 2020–2023 | 110/110 cum laude
**Universidad Politécnica de Madrid** | Research exchange in Explainable AI | 2022–2023 | 10/10, top 5% of thesis work
Thesis: *Robustness of Ensemble Explanations (AXOM)* | Thesis PDF · Executive summary

## SELECTED PROJECTS & PUBLICATION

**ACM RecSys Challenge 2022 (co-author):** Lightweight Model for Session-Based Recommender Systems with Seasonality Information in the Fashion Domain. Paper (DOI)
**Projects:** Portfolio

## CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

**Confluent Certified Developer for Apache Kafka (CCDAK)** – Feb 2026
**Languages:** English C1 (TOEIC 955) | Spanish conversational | Italian native